



RONALDO BOLAÑOS Los Angeles Times

SOMETHING TO SHOUT ABOUT

U.S. and Paraguay fans parade to the first World Cup match at SoFi Stadium on Friday. Visit [latimes.com/enewspaper](#) for the game result and page B10 and [latimes.com/worldcup](#) for more coverage.

SpaceX shares rise 19% on stock market

The rocket company’s historic IPO makes CEO Musk the world’s first trillionaire.

By LAURENCE DARMIENTO

SpaceX, the once fledgling aerospace company that Elon Musk predicted had a slim chance of survival, reached new heights on Friday with a historic initial public offering.

Shares of SpaceX, trading under the ticker SPXC, closed the day at \$160.95, 19% above the offering price, transforming it into one of the world’s most valuable companies with a \$2.2-trillion market cap. The IPO also made the 54-year-old Musk the world’s first trillionaire.

The IPO capped a remarkable journey for a 24-year-old company that nearly shut down after a series of failed launches until its Falcon 1 rocket in 2008 orbited the Earth and clinched a crucial NASA contract.

“It is certainly hard to believe that a little company that started in a warehouse in El Segundo is now going public with the largest IPO ever,” Musk told cheering employees at the company’s Texas headquarters.

The company raised \$75 billion in the offering after selling 555 million shares at \$135 to institutional and retail investors. With the shares in high demand, SpaceX could raise even more money.

It granted the nearly two dozen underwriters of the IPO, led by Goldman Sachs and Morgan Stanley, an additional 83 million shares, which could raise its total take to \$86 billion.

The IPO is easily the largest on record, surpassing the 2019 offering by Saudi Aramco, Saudi Arabia’s state-owned oil giant, which raised \$29.4 billion.

“They clearly priced it right, at least for one day. It should just make you optimistic for the markets for, especially for growth stocks,” said Robert Gruendyke, senior portfolio manager at Allspring Global Investments.

Musk has big plans for the company, which already dominates the world’s rocket launch business and is the leading satellite-based broadband provider with its Starlink service. It also has spent billions to buy spectrum for satellite-based

[See **SpaceX**, A12]

DAVID HOCKNEY, 1937 – 2026

British artist became a Los Angeles visionary

In his paintings, pools and lawns rise to fine art

By JESSICA GELT AND BARBARA ISENBERG

David Hockney, the innovative and prolific British artist who arrived in Los Angeles in 1964, soon celebrating its sun-drenched life and landscapes in colorful, wildly popular paintings, died Thursday at his home in London. He was 88.

His death was confirmed in a statement by his publicist Erica Bolton.

Calling himself “an English Los Angeleno,” Hockney immortalized the city’s sparkling swimming pools, palm trees and beautiful young men, then went on to experiment with intricate photo collages, portrait suites, painted and filmed im-

ages of Yorkshire landscapes, iPad drawings and more.

“Los Angeles will always be thought of by many people worldwide through the images that David created,” said Stephanie Barron, senior curator and head of the modern art department at Los Angeles County Museum of Art, which holds more than 150 works by Hockney in its permanent collection. “But for me one of David’s greatest gifts was his ability to look at the world with wonder and joy in whatever medium he decided to work in. ... He was fearless in his embrace of technology, and I think that enormous curiosity ran throughout his career, and continued to the end. He was involved in looking at art history and the future simultaneously.”

[See **Hockney**, A9]



Los Angeles Times

COLORFUL INNOVATOR

Hockney, sitting in front of some of his paintings inside his Hollywood Hills studio in 2017, also worked in photography, video and iPad drawings.

Five essential works that capture his glimmering city

By JESSICA GELT

David Hockney, the towering English artist who made Los Angeles his home, created many pieces that epitomized the city’s sun-drenched landscapes filled with glittering pools, rolling hills and lush foliage. Here are five of his best.

“Mulholland Drive: The Road to the Studio,” 1980

Hockney’s largest canvas — at more than 7 feet tall and 20 feet wide — is filled with deft lines and Hockney’s signature

swirls. It depicts the artist’s daily commute from his home in the Hollywood Hills to his studio on Santa Monica Boulevard. The iconic winding road from the painting’s title twists and sweeps through hills of blue, purple and pink. A swimming pool and tennis courts can be seen in the background and the landscape is dotted with power lines and trees. Cross-hatched grids in the background represent the vastness of the surrounding areas, including Burbank and Studio City. That the canvas is a representation of driving — one of the city’s core activities — makes it especially reso-

[See **Five works**, A9]

Heavily Latino areas voted for Bass in primary

Incumbent mayor had far more supporters in such neighborhoods than Raman, Pratt.

By NOAH GOLDBERG, MELISSA GOMEZ AND SANDHYA KAMBHAMPATI

Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass carried far more Latino-majority neighborhoods than her rivals in last week’s primary election, an analysis of precinct data shows, helping her finish first and qualify for the Nov. 3 runoff with City Councilmember Nithya Raman.

Bass carried 35 Latino-majority neighborhoods, including Boyle Heights, Pacoima and Historic South-Central. That was a 46% increase from 2022, when she won 24 Latino-majority neighborhoods in a primary race against Rick Caruso and Kevin de León, according to a Times analysis of election data.

Raman was a distant second, winning seven Latino-majority neighborhoods, including Highland Park, El Sereno and Lincoln Heights.

Pratt threatens rivals in video

Former reality TV star attacks Bass and Raman after losing the mayoral race. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Pratt won a single Latino-majority neighborhood, Harbor City, which is 51% Latino, the analysis found.

Bass’ strong showing among Latinos was credited in part to her forceful challenge of the Trump administration’s immigration raids and mass detentions last year.

“Latinos came out for her because she has done a really, really good job in trying to fight the Trump administration,” said Nilza Serrano, the president of Avance Democratic Club, a Latino Democratic organization, which endorsed Bass.

Avance endorsed Caruso in the runoff with Bass four years ago, leading Bass to suggest Caruso bought their support. She later apologized to the group. This time around, she worked behind

[See **Latinos**, A7]

Justice Dept. OKs Warner Bros. sale

Regulators will allow \$11-billion Paramount merger to proceed in reshaping Hollywood.

By MEG JAMES

The U.S. Justice Department has cleared the way for Paramount Skydance’s \$11-billion purchase of Warner Bros. Discovery — a major milestone that moves David Ellison closer to his goal.

After a months-long review, Justice Department antitrust regulators on Friday concluded the combination would not violate federal anticompetition laws. Approval had been expected because President Trump — who has friendly ties with

Ellison and his father, tech billionaire Larry Ellison — favors the deal.

The government stopped short of asking Paramount to make concessions or divestitures.

Buying Warner Bros. would allow Paramount — Hollywood’s smallest major company — to bulk up with such prestigious properties as HBO, CNN, HGTV and Food Network. Those would be combined with properties Paramount already owns, including CBS, Comedy Central, Nickelodeon and MTV.

The deal would put two historic film studios and two prominent news organizations under the same roof. It would give Paramount four streaming services, includ-

[See **Merger**, A7]

COLUMN ONE

Jeweler tarnished as suspicions grow

An O.C. gem expert’s reputation was golden, but clients now say he took them for fools.

By ALENE TCHEKMEDYAN

In certain circles, Nelson Holdo was the go-to guy for fine jewelry and luxury watches.

He ingratiated himself with the wealthy, touting his charitable donations and trips to Geneva, the world’s watchmaking capital. He hosted extravagant poker nights where players smoked cigars and cashed out chips toward pieces worn by roving models. Clients offered glowing referrals to friends.

And so, they trusted him

to brighten their special days. A father of three wired him \$38,700 for three Rolexes — Christmas gifts for his kids after he beat non-Hodgkin lymphoma. A groom paid \$27,000 for two Rolex Datejust watches for his father and his future father-in-law. A couple fell in love with a 3.6-carat diamond, splurging \$60,000 for their engagement.

But for some, when it came time to settle up, Holdo was full of excuses. The gems never materialized.

As lawsuits piled up — dozens, over the decades — Holdo started new businesses in new places. More recently, even after prosecutors filed criminal charges accusing him of stealing from his customers, he made deals while free on bail.

“Over the years, people

[See **Jeweler**, A8]

Struggle for ICE oversight

House Democrats ask to roll back policies that restrict their access to detainees. **NATION, A4**

No evidence for Skid Row scheme

Pratt supporters are peddling unfounded claims of voter fraud online. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Doctor for Rams, Dodgers queried

ElAttrache talks to MLB after report he suggested PEDs for UFC star. **SPORTS, B12**

Weather
Partly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 81/63. **B8**

Markets **A12**
Opinion Voices **A13**

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